



SkyDrive gets selective

Microsoft added a feature to its SkyDrive cloud storage service, that lets users sync only selected folders (but not files)



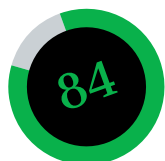
Hacked PS3's face the axe

Sony responds to PS3 hack doing rounds with direct warning to users and threaten "permanent termination" from Sony Online Services

Bazaar

Sony XBA 3

An excellent pair of headphones, marred by one maddening flaw



Accessories	90
Performance	85
Build Quality	85
Value for Money	75

Specifications

Sensitivity: 108dB; **Power Handling:** 100 mW;
Cord: 1.2m; **Frequency:** 4-28,000Hz

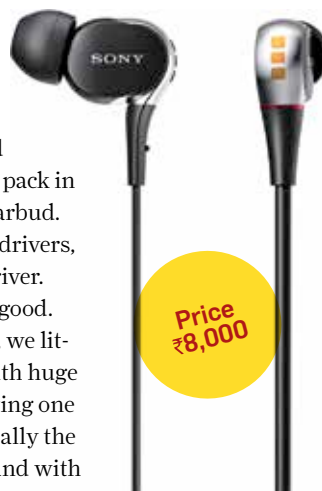
Contact

Sony India
Website: www.sony.co.in
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The Sony XBA series of earphones were one that we were quite eager to try out. The balanced armature design which Sony has employed (hence the XBA name) allows Sony to pack in up to four discrete drivers into each earbud. The XBA 3 comes with three discrete drivers, a tweeter, a woofer and a full-range driver.

These earphones are good, really good. When we initially tried the speakers, we literally wandered around the office with huge smiles plastered across our faces, trying one track after another. The audio, especially the highs, were very nicely reproduced and with none of the screechiness that accompanies most in-ear sets. The bass was also excellent and never seemed overpowered.

The problem we faced with these earphones was with regards to heavy, action-packed tracks such as those from Metallica or Dream Theatre among



Price
₹8,000

others. While the tracks sounded good, for some reason it felt like the XBA-3 couldn't handle the load at the fast-paced sections, with certain frequencies getting a bit muted at times. Overall, these are an excellent pair of earphones as long as you're listening to the right tracks. For those interested in classical music or opera, or generally vocal heavy tracks, this set is sublime; for fans of metal and rock, a strict no-no.

The overall packaging of these earphones is nice and they come with every possible earbud that you may need. It also comes with a very nice carrying case as well as a 'Cord

Adjuster' to adjust the length of the cord. For more information on balanced armature drivers, head over to <http://dgit.in/Q9I96Z>

Anirudh Regidi

Canon Canoscan 9000F

An excellent film scanner, not so good for anything else

In this day and age of everything digital, film scanners are something of a rarity among the average users and it is probably something that someone would buy if they have a few old memories (film) that they need scanned. This scanner is a very decent performer overall and while it does fall short when scanning images, it does a very good job with film negatives. On the default settings, most colour documents we scanned had overly saturated colours or slightly washed out images depending on whether we were scanning in magazine mode or colour photo mode. There was also quite a bit of noise present in the colour scans. The scans were extremely well-detailed however, with every flaw in the paper and print standing out.

Scanning negatives was an entirely different matter though. The scanner comes bundled with a few assorted guide strips for 35mm to 120mm film and setting up the negatives on them was a breeze. Scan times

were easily above 2 minutes for a 35mm negative at 4800dpi, but the quality of the output was excellent.

The scan process is also simple and there is no hassle with regards to inverting the colours on the negative and such.

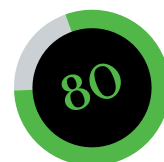
This is not a scanner we would recommend for scanning documents and prints, but as a negative scanner, it does stand out.

The price is a tad too high and 30 per cent more than what it sells for abroad, but for a person in real need of a film scanner, this can be a good deal.

Anirudh Regidi



Price
₹14,995



Accessories	85
Performance	85
Build Quality	80
Value for Money	70

Specifications

Scanner Element: CCD
12-line colour; **Light Source:** White LED; **Selectable resolution:** 25-19200dpi;
Max document size: A4/Letter

Contact

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